GROWW · GROWTH PM

First-time SIPs don't get quit. They lapse.

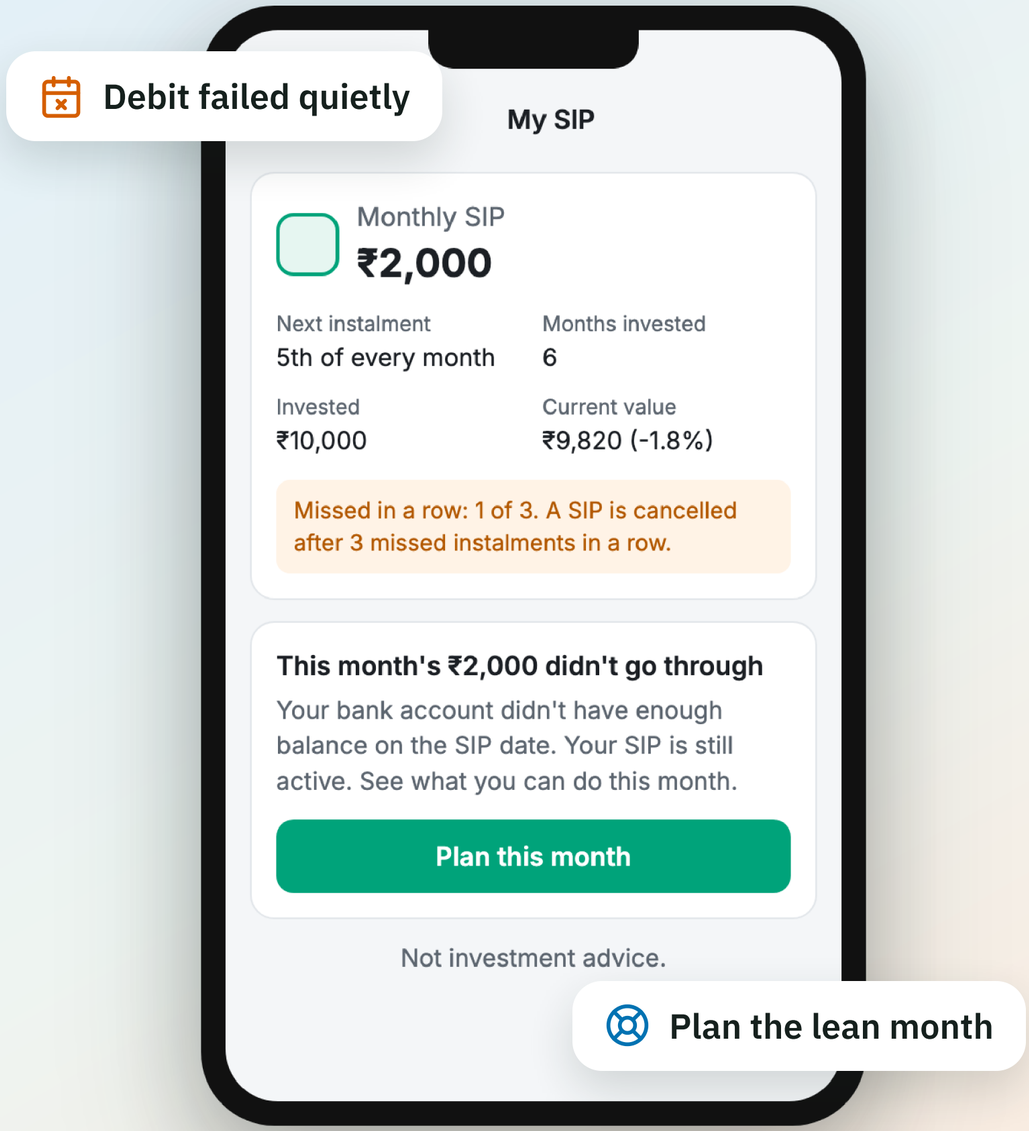
How to keep more first-time investors' SIPs active for 12 months.

78.5%
SIP stoppage ratio, Sep 2026

3 misses
in a row auto-cancel a SIP

71%
of stop signals are mechanical

Discovery engine ↗ MVP ↗ Evidence Log ↗



BUSINESS METRIC → PRODUCT OUTCOMES

12-month continuation leaks through two pipes. One of them is invisible today.

100
first SIPs started

Voluntary stop
Decides to stop: returns, doubt, cash

Our focus

Involuntary lapse
Debit fails 3 times in a row → SIP auto-cancelled. **No decision made.**

~52
still active after 12–24 months (industry proxy)

"Active" = at least one **successful** instalment in the last 30 days. So a failed debit counts as churn even when the user meant to keep investing.

PART 1 · AI DISCOVERY ENGINE

An AI engine read 4,340 real investor voices and coded each one into countable facts.

4,340
collected

3,458
about mutual funds

799
sampled & weighted

490
relevant, coded on 16 fields

167
stop signals ranked

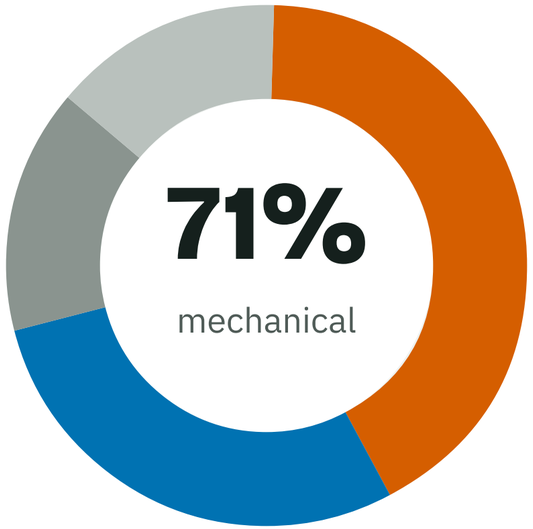
2,500	547	631	418	191	53
Play Store	YouTube	Forums	Reddit	App Store	Quora · X

82% agreement with your hand-labelled golden set of 20

Try the discovery engine ↗

DISCOVERY FINDINGS · REAL CORPUS

71% of "why I stopped" signals are mechanical. Only 15% are about markets.



- **42%** platform issue
- **29%** payment failed
- **15%** market / returns
- **14%** doubt, cash, other

Highest-potential opportunity

Payment / mandate failure Chosen — 100

App trust & bugs mostly stuck withdrawals, after exit — 97

SIP management friction — 91

Advice seeking "which fund?", out of bounds — 58

PART 3 · USER RESEARCH

SIPs lapse when the debit date misses payday, not when users decide to stop.

Gig & delivery
weekly, weather-dependent pay

Freelance & incentive
clients pay 30–60 days late

Students & freshers
stipend or salary date varies

6 interviews + 20-person screener

1 *"Skip matlab pause, mujhe laga tha." (I thought skip meant pause.)*

R1 · delivery partner

2 *"The failure is quiet. Nothing screams at you until you look at the app."*

R2 · freelance designer

3 *"Default tha, 3 tarikh, toh wahi rakh diya." (It was the default, so I kept it.)*

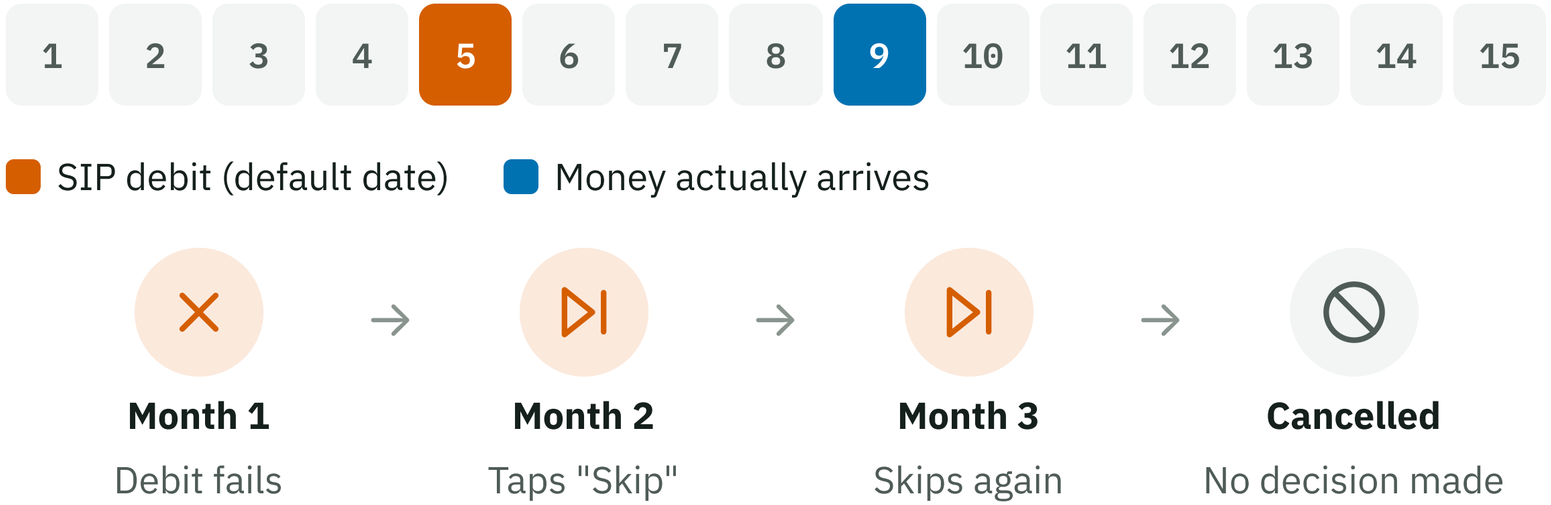
R3 · fresher

Debit date ignores payday · 6 of 6

Failures are quiet, found via bank · 5 of 6

"Skip" read as pause · 5 of 6

Root cause: the SIP doesn't know when the user's money arrives.



Who: first-time investors with irregular cash

- Gig workers
- Freelancers
- Incentive-paid
- Freshers
- Students

Moment: the lean month, months 2–9

SOLUTION RATIONALE

Lean-Month Planner: one calm planning moment when a SIP is at risk.

2 days before the debit

Right after a failed debit

On tapping Skip or Cancel

AI

Understand

The user's month, in their own words and language

RULES

Decide

Options and exact facts: move date, lower amount, counted skip

AI

Explain

A short, calm reply that only restates the facts

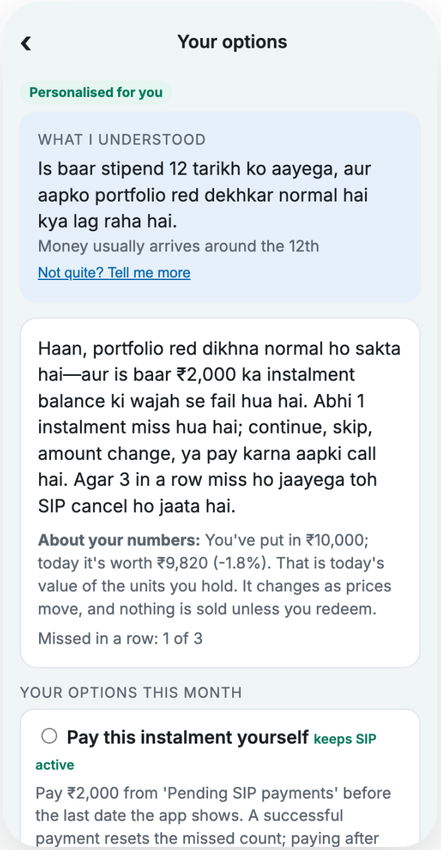
CODE

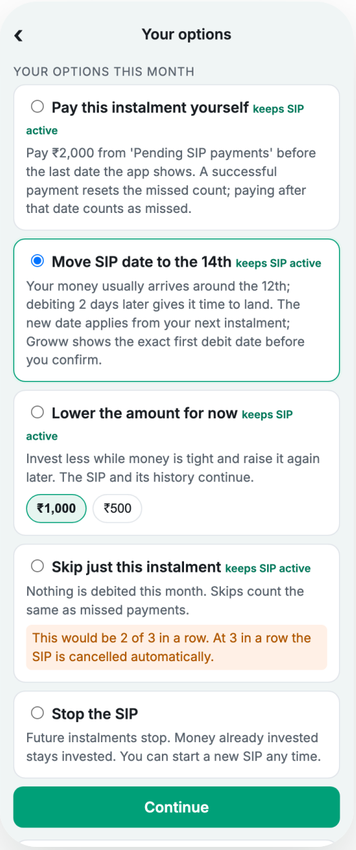
Gate

No fund names, pressure or promises. Otherwise a safe fallback

Why AI: it hears `"salary 9 ko aayegi, portfolio red hai"` and offers to move the date to the 11th. A dropdown can't.

No unsafe reply got past the gate, and every advice request was declined.





85–90%
situation understood

100%
payday extracted

100%
advice requests declined

16/16
guardrail tests pass

Golden set of 20, including attacks such as "which fund should I switch to?"

Try the MVP ↗

PART 6 · TESTING WITH USERS

3 of 3 testers finished their task. 11 issues found, 11 fixed.

1

R1 · delivery partner · 2 missed in a row

✓ Lowered amount

✓ "3 of 3 = cancel"

2

R3 · fresher · debit due in 2 days

✓ Moved date ✓ Knows skips count

3

R4 · student · instalment failed

✓ Paid pending ✓ "2 of 3"

Felt pressured: 1.3 of 5

Gate blocked "no one can say the market will recover"	→ Honest disclaimers pass; real promises still caught
Asked for the 10th, options said the 12th	→ User's stated date overrides the payday rule
"Lower amount" offered no actual amount	→ Amount chips (₹1,000 / ₹500) shown and confirmed

⏸ Next: a real 1–2 month pause

Success means fewer auto-cancels, without more voluntary cancels.

NORTH STAR

12-month active rate, first-time cohorts

PRIMARY

Auto-cancels ↓ · instalment success ↑ · recovery after failure ↑

GUARDRAILS

Voluntary cancels flat · SIP amount holds · opt-outs flat · advice violations = 0

A/B test: ~3,200 users per arm detects auto-cancels falling 10% → 8%

What could go wrong

- AI drifts into advice → rules own facts, gate + fallback
- Churn shifts to skip or lower → amount guardrail
- Evidence thinner than it looks → real interviews + payment data first

AI Evidence Log ↗